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MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM
MGU-UGP (HONOURS) REGULAR EXAMINATION March 2026
Fourth SEMESTER
Discipline Specific Core Course (DSC) - MG4DSCHIS201 - PERSPECTIVES ON PRE-COLONIAL INDIA

Part A

Short Answer Questions
Answer any **10** questions

1. Palas:- Eraly medieval dynasty (8th-12th Century CE) – Bengal and parts of Bihar –
2. Bharatavarsha:- not an ancient name of India – not a political concept – cultural concept- meaning varied over centuries.
3. Monarchical character of early medieval states:- early medieval monarchies – kings – grand titles – claimed divine sanction – rulers of Rashtrakutas, Palas, Prathiharas, Chalukyas, Pallavas, Hoysalas, Cheras, Cholas, Pandyas, etc.
4. Who were the Mongolians?:- East Asian warrior group – Chengiz Khan – Timur - Mongol attacks on the Delhi Sultanate.
5. Diwan-i-Riyasat:- department in the Delhi sultanate - Department of Commerce or State Affairs related to markets.
6. Malfusath:- Sufi literature – collection of the discourses, teachings and conversations of Sufi Saints.
7. Muquddam:- Village headmen under the Delhi Sultanate and the Mughals.
8. Alamgir:- Aurangazeb assumed the title Alamgir when he ascended the throne.
9. Integration of Rajputs into Mughal administration:- Major officers – Mansabdars – Revenue administration – Matrimonial alliance – Raja Mansigh, Birbal, Raja Todarmal, jodha Bai.
10. Mention two centres of textile production in Mughal India:- Gujarat, Bengal, etc.
11. Scientific contribution of Sawai Jai Singh:- astronomical observatories called Jantar Mantar – astronomical instruments.
12. Amaram:- Land assignment during the Vijayanagara Empire – Amaranayakas.

Part B

Short Essay Questions
Answer any **6** questions

13. Achievements of Rajendra I:- overran the Pandyas and Cholas – conquest of Sri Lanka – conquest of the Sri Vijaya empire in Malay peninsula, Sumatra, Java and the neighbouring islands - march across Kalinga to Bengal by crossing the river Ganga – Gangaikondachola - Gangaikondacholapuram – improvement of trade.
14. Turkish rule in India:- Turkish conquest – Mahmud Ghazni – Ghazanvid Empire – plunder – Muhammad Ghori – Ghurid Empire – Battles of Tarain – establishment of the Delhi Sultanate.
15. Balban:- Turkish nobles Chahalgani (forty) - suppressed their power - “sijada” (prostration) and “paibos” (kissing the feet of the Sultan) - introduced the Persian festival Nauroz – claimed Sultan was God’s shadow on earth – claimed descendant of an Iranian legendary ruler, Afrasiab – reorganised the army.

16. Firoz Shah Tughlaq:- taccavi loans (agricultural loans) - survey of crop production - dug wells - irrigation canals; Yamuna canal.
17. Alauddin Khilji:- controlled the nobility - reorganised the army – market regulation – resisted Mongol invasions – conquests over the Rajput states - conquest of the Deccan and the far South.
18. The importance of trade during the Delhi Sultanate:- overland trade; Persian Gulf and Red Sea regions – coastal trade – inter-regional trade – Traders; Marwaris, Gujaratis, Bohra merchants, Mulatanis, Khurasanis – dalals – transport and communication – urbanization – cities; Delhi, Daulatabad, Lahore, etc.
19. Causes of the decline of the Mughal Empire:- weak successors of Aurangazeb – Policies of Aurangazeb – foreign invasions – emergence of new principalities – Mughal nobility – rising power of the British
20. Literature and history writing under the Mughal Empire:- Babur; Tuzuk-i-Babari – Humayun; Humayun Namah – Akbar; Ain-i-Akbari and Akbar Namah, Muntakhab-ul-Tawarikh; Abul Fazal and Badauni – Jahangir; Tuzuk-i-Jahangiri – Shah Jahan; Padshah Namah – Aurangazeb; Alamgir Namah – translations – foreign travellers' accounts.
21. Social composition of Mughal India:- ruling class; royal family, nobles – religious groups ; Ulemas, Ghasis – Zamindars – Peasants; Khudkashta, Pahis, Muzariams – artisans and craftsmen – merchants and traders
22. Central administration of the Marathas:- Sivaji – Ashtapradhan – Peshwa – Sar-i-Naubat – Majumdar – Waqenavis – Surunavis – Sumanta – Nyayadhish – Pandit Rao – administrative reforms of Sivaji.

Part C

Essay Questions

Answer any **2** questions

23. Origin and rise of the Rajput polities:- early medieval period – regional kingdoms – claimed kshatriya lineage – claimed agnikula origin – warrior clans – Rajastan, Gujarat, central India, parts of Indo-Gangetic regions - Chauhans, Paramaras, Solankis, Gahadavalas, and Rathores.
24. Impact of the Bhakti and Sufi movements:- Bhakti in south India; Alwars and Nayanars – in north India; Namadeva, Ramananda, Kabir, Nanak, Nath Pandhi, etc. – Sufism - Wahdat-ul-wujud - Silsilahs - Chishti and Suhrawardi - message of love and personal devotion to God – denounced the caste system - emphasised the unity of God - equality and brotherhood -
25. Mansabdari System:- Akbar – nobility and army – Mansab (rank) and Mansabdars – zat and sawar – dagh and chehra – highest paid service – strengthen the army
26. Commercial capitalism in India:- sixteenth to the nineteenth centuries – colonial powers – mercantilism - arrival of European maritime powers - the Portuguese, the Dutch, the French and the English – East India Companies – transition from trade to political control - the Battle of Plassey (1757) and the Battle of Buxar (1764) - colonial commercial capitalis - economic exploitation – integration to global capitalism – India became supplier of raw materials for British industries- market for British goods – drain of wealth.